



English Name _____

Student Number _____

Class _____

UCLC1013 EAP I Essay Plan

Please type your essay plan below. Your **essay plan** must be submitted to **iSpace** before the deadline on **Sunday, 11th October, 06:00 AM**.

Essay Prompt: *Discuss the main factors affecting cross-cultural communication.*

Theme 1: Social Organization (SO)

Sources: Triandis (2002), Mehra (2014)

Background:

SO = driver of interaction & societal role functioning

SO patterns – reflection of deep cultural values

Cultural value variations = differing attitudes toward authority & hierarchy

→ impact on communication + decision-making

Sub Point 1: Cultural framework

Explanation and Evidence for Sub Point 1:

Vertical cultures vs. horizontal cultures = cultural orientations impacting communication



Horizontal structure =
high value on equality & collaborative choices
(e.g., Sweden & Denmark)

Vertical structure = centrality of rank & authority (e.g., Japan & China)
(Triandis, 2002)

Sub Point 2: Power distance concept

Explanation and Evidence for Sub Point 2:

Mismatched authority expectations → misunderstanding & workplace inefficiency
e.g.,

* Collaborative context + reliance on hierarchical power = reduced productivity

* Deference setting + open debate = disruptive behavior

(Mehra, 2014)

Theme 2: Non-verbal Communication (NC)

Sources: Hall (1959), Hall (1976), Dupraw and Axner (1997), Reference for Business (n.d.)



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Background:

NC = expression of meaning beyond words

Silent cues – reflection of embedded cultural norms & values

Unrecognized behavioral differences → communication barriers & interaction breakdown → misunderstanding (Dupraw & Axner, 1997)

Sub Point 1: Communication contexts

Explanation and Evidence for Sub Point 1:

High-context implicit signaling vs low-context explicit verbal clarity (Hall, 1976)

implicit systems =
meaning from context &
indirect signals

explicit systems =
focus on literal vocabulary &
clear verbal statements

∴ Misinterpretation → barriers to effective interaction

Sub Point 2: Personal space

Explanation and Evidence for Sub Point 2:

High-proximity preferences vs high-distance preferences (Reference for Business, n.d.)

(e.g., Asia & Middle East)
Closer physical proximity

(e.g., US & Northern Europe)
more personal space

∴ Misinterpretation of personal space = Clashing proximity boundaries
→ unintentional rudeness & cultural gaps